

Sentinel (sntlabs.io) - Bottom-of-Funnel SEO & Webpage Optimization Strategy

Targeting Small-to-Medium Firms | April 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Current State: sntlabs.io ranks for exactly **1 organic keyword** ("sentinel labs" at position 65, 140 vol). Zero backlinks, zero organic traffic, zero AI visibility. Authority Score: n/a.

The Opportunity: Competitors (Everlaw 3.3K keywords, Exterro 5.3K, Relativity 5.5K, DISCO 1.8K) dominate, but most focus on enterprise. The small/mid-firm segment is **underserved** and keyword difficulty is LOW (avg KD 12-20% for core terms). Sentinel's converged platform (eDiscovery + compliance + GRC + surveillance + AI) gives it a unique positioning no single competitor can match.

Strategy: Build a BOFU-first content engine using Edward Sturm's "Compact Keywords" approach + AI search optimization to capture high-intent buyers at the decision stage.

PART 1: SEMRUSH KEYWORD GAP ANALYSIS

Competitor Keyword Overlap (via Semrush Keyword Gap, April 9, 2026)

Domain	Organic Keywords	Authority
sntlabs.io	1	n/a
everlaw.com	3,300	High
exterro.com	5,300	High
relativity.com	5,500	High
csdisco.com	1,800	Medium

185 missing keywords where competitors rank but Sentinel does not.

13,900 untapped keywords in the broader competitive landscape.

PART 2: PRIORITIZED KEYWORD TARGETS

TIER 1 - EASY WINS (KD 0-14%) - Immediate Priority

These are ultra-low competition keywords Sentinel can rank for within 30-60 days with well-optimized content.

Keyword	Volume	KD%	Content Type
deposition transcript review software	90	3	Product page
deposition transcript management software	90	7	Product page
deposition review software	90	8	Product page
deposition summary software	110	9	Product page
deposition transcript software	110	10	Product/listicle
conflicts compliance monitoring software	90	10	Product page
early case assessment	260	15	Guide + product
ediscovery law firms	170	15	Landing page
cloud ediscovery	70	16	Product page
legal hold definition	210	16	Educational + product
legal hold meaning	170	18	Educational + product
legal hold technology	90	18	Product page
bank compliance monitoring software	70	18	Vertical landing page

TIER 2 - EASY WINS (KD 15-29%) - 30-90 Day Priority

Keyword	Volume	KD%	Content Type
deposition software	140	20	Pillar page
what is legal hold	320	20	FAQ/guide
what is a legal hold	480	21	FAQ/guide
document review platforms	90	21	Comparison listicle
ediscovery platforms	320	22	Comparison listicle
litigation hold definition	140	23	Educational
what are legal holds	170	23	FAQ page
legal holds	210	24	Pillar page
what is a legal hold notice	170	24	FAQ
legal hold tools	140	24	Comparison listicle
legal hold software	480	26	Product/comparison
best ediscovery software	140	26	Listicle
ediscovery for law firms	140	27	Landing page
e-discovery services	170	28	Service page
regulatory compliance monitoring software	210	25	Product page
compliance monitoring software	720	28	Pillar page

Keyword	Volume	KD%	Content Type
ediscovery software for small law firms	110	19	Landing page
document review platform	90	25	Product page
document review platforms	90	21	Comparison page
litigation hold software	140	22	Product page

TIER 3 - HIGH-VALUE COMPETITIVE (KD 30-49%) - 90+ Day Priority

Keyword	Volume	KD%	Content Type
ediscovery	5,400	46	Pillar page
e-discovery	2,400	44	Alt pillar
ediscovery software	1,600	37	Comparison
e discovery software	720	35	Product
legal hold	1,000	31	Pillar page
what is ediscovery	880	41	Guide
legal document review software	110	70	Product

EMERGING/ZERO-COMPETITION KEYWORDS (n/a KD)

These have no established competition — first mover advantage:

Keyword	Volume	Why Target
best compliance monitoring software for highly regulated sectors	90	Perfect Sentinel positioning
ai compliance monitoring software with audit integrations	70	AI + compliance = Sentinel
new ediscovery review platform	1,900	High volume, n/a KD
best software for automating legal document review	20	BOFU buying intent
legal document review ai software	20	AI differentiator
platforms for integrated communications surveillance compliance	0	Category-defining

PART 3: CONTENT ARCHITECTURE - PAGE-BY-PAGE PLAN

A. Pillar Pages (4 pages)

1. "eDiscovery Software for Small & Mid-Size Law Firms"

- Target: ediscovery software, ediscovery platforms, ediscovery for law firms, ediscovery software for small law firms
- Combined volume: ~2,500+
- Format: Long-form guide (3,000+ words) with comparison table, buyer's guide structure
- Schema: Product, FAQ, HowTo
- Sentinel differentiation: Show how converged platform eliminates bolt-on integrations

2. "Legal Hold Software & Compliance Management"

- Target: legal hold software, legal hold, legal holds, what is a legal hold, legal hold tools
- Combined volume: ~2,200+
- Format: Educational guide transitioning to product solution
- Schema: FAQ, Article, Product
- Sentinel differentiation: Privilege-by-design architecture, automated hold workflows

3. "Compliance Monitoring Software for Regulated Industries"

- Target: compliance monitoring software, regulatory compliance monitoring software, bank compliance monitoring software
- Combined volume: ~1,000+
- Format: Industry-specific guide with use cases (financial services, healthcare, legal)
- Schema: Product, FAQ, Organization
- Sentinel differentiation: AI violation detection across 30+ rule types, real-time communication surveillance

4. "AI-Powered Deposition & Document Review Platform"

- Target: deposition software, deposition transcript software, deposition summary software, document review platform
- Combined volume: ~700+
- Format: Product-focused landing page with demo CTA
- Schema: Product, FAQ, SoftwareApplication
- Sentinel differentiation: AI interview module, ambient intelligence, GPT-5/Gemini/Claude integration

B. Comparison/Listicle Pages (6 pages) — HIGHEST AI CITATION POTENTIAL

Per 2026 data: "Best X" listicles account for **43.8% of all page types cited by ChatGPT**.

5. "Best eDiscovery Software for Small Law Firms [2026]"

- Target: best ediscovery software, ediscovery software for small law firms, new ediscovery review platform
- Format: Ranked listicle with transparent evaluation criteria (pricing, features, firm size fit)
- Include: Relativity, Everlaw, DISCO, Reveal, Sentinel — position Sentinel as the converged alternative
- Word count: 4,000+ (pages >20K characters get 4x more AI citations)

6. "Best Legal Hold Software & Tools Compared [2026]"

- Target: legal hold software, legal hold tools, litigation hold software
- Format: Comparison table + detailed reviews
- Competitors covered: Exterro, Relativity, Zapproved, Sentinel

7. "Best Compliance Monitoring Software for Financial Services [2026]"

- Target: compliance monitoring software, bank compliance monitoring, best compliance monitoring software for highly regulated sectors

- Format: Vertical-specific listicle
- Competitors: Smarsh, Global Relay, Theta Lake, Sentinel

8. "Sentinel vs Relativity: eDiscovery Platform Comparison"

- Target: relativity legal document review software, ediscovery alternatives
- Format: Head-to-head comparison with feature matrix
- Key angle: Sentinel's converged platform vs Relativity's eDiscovery-only approach

9. "Sentinel vs Everlaw: Which eDiscovery Platform for Mid-Size Firms?"

- Target: everlaw alternative, ediscovery platform comparison
- Format: Head-to-head comparison

10. "Sentinel vs Exterro: Legal GRC & eDiscovery Compared"

- Target: exterro alternative, legal grc software
- Format: Head-to-head — Sentinel's AI stack vs Exterro's legacy approach

C. FAQ/Educational Pages (5 pages)

11. "What Is a Legal Hold? Complete Guide for Law Firms"

- Target: what is a legal hold, what is legal hold, legal hold definition, legal hold meaning, define legal hold, what are legal holds, what is a legal hold notice
- Combined volume: ~1,700+
- Format: Comprehensive FAQ with schema markup
- Every question = potential AI Overview snippet

12. "What Is eDiscovery? The Complete 2026 Guide"

- Target: what is ediscovery, what is e discovery, electronic discovery
- Format: Educational pillar with progressive disclosure to product

13. "Early Case Assessment: How AI Is Transforming Litigation Preparation"

- Target: early case assessment, litigation support technology
- Format: Guide + case study

14. "eDiscovery Processing: How Modern Platforms Handle Data at Scale"

- Target: ediscovery processing, e discovery forensics, ediscovery cloud, ediscovery hosting
- Format: Technical guide showing Sentinel's processing capabilities

15. "Communication Surveillance & Compliance: The 2026 Regulatory Landscape"

- Target: communication surveillance compliance, communications surveillance compliance news
- Format: Thought leadership + product positioning
- Category-defining content for Sentinel's unique moat

D. Vertical/Use Case Landing Pages (4 pages)

16. "eDiscovery for Solo & Small Firm Attorneys"

- Persona: Solo practitioners and 2-10 attorney firms
- Messaging: Affordable, easy to use, no IT team required
- CTA: Free trial / demo

17. "Compliance Solutions for Financial Services Firms"

- Persona: Community banks, credit unions, boutique investment firms
- Target: bank compliance monitoring software, covenant compliance monitoring software
- Messaging: SEC/FINRA compliance, communication surveillance

18. "AI-Powered Deposition Solutions for Litigation Teams"

- Persona: Litigation partners at mid-size firms
- Target: deposition software, AI deposition summarization, remote deposition software
- Messaging: AI transcription, summary generation, ambient intelligence

19. "Document Review & Production for Corporate Legal Departments"

- Persona: In-house legal teams at mid-market companies
- Target: document review platform, legal document management software
- Messaging: Reduce outside counsel spend, privilege-by-design

PART 4: EDWARD STURM'S "COMPACT KEYWORDS" + VIDEO STRATEGY

What Sturm Recommends for 2026

Edward Sturm's core insight: **Target each BOFU keyword with BOTH a webpage AND multiple short videos.** Each video goes to every platform (YouTube, TikTok, Instagram Reels, LinkedIn, Facebook Reels). This creates "maximum coverage" on the keyword.

Implementation for Sentinel

For each Tier 1 and Tier 2 keyword, create:

1. **One optimized webpage** (the pages above)
2. **2-3 short videos** (60-90 seconds) per keyword topic:
 - "What is [keyword]? Explained in 60 seconds"
 - "How Sentinel solves [keyword problem]"
 - "Sentinel vs [competitor] for [keyword]"

Video Production Approach:

- Casual, authentic UGC-style (Google/AI search prioritizes UGC)
- Keyword in title, first 3 words
- Video transcript becomes the description
- Links in YouTube and Facebook Reels descriptions (clickable)
- 10 minutes per video total (Sturm's benchmark)

Priority Video Topics:

1. "What is a legal hold?" (480 vol)
2. "eDiscovery for small law firms" (170 vol)
3. "Deposition summary software demo" (110 vol)
4. "Compliance monitoring for banks" (70 vol)
5. "Sentinel vs Relativity in 60 seconds"

PART 5: AI SEARCH OPTIMIZATION (GEO/AEO)

2026 Reality Check

- AI Overviews appear in **82% of B2B technology searches**
- Being cited in AI Overviews increases brand clicks by **35%**
- #1 organic position loses **34.5% CTR** when AI Overview is present
- Bottom-funnel content (case studies, pricing pages) gets the **highest AI referral traffic**
- Pages above 20,000 characters average **10.18 AI citations** vs 2.39 for short pages

How to Get Sentinel Cited in AI Search

1. Schema Markup Everything

- Organization schema for Sentinel/SNT Labs
- Product schema for each module (eDiscovery, compliance monitoring, GRC, deposition tools)
- FAQ schema on every page with real buyer questions
- SoftwareApplication schema with pricing, features, platform details
- Define relationships between entities (Sentinel -> offers -> eDiscovery software)

2. Create "Cite-Worthy" Content

- Original data and benchmarks (e.g., "We processed 10M documents in X hours")
- Case studies with specific metrics (REQUIRED per Google March 2026 core update)
- Transparent evaluation criteria in comparison pages
- Clear, direct answers to questions in the first paragraph

3. Structure for LLM Extraction

- H2/H3 headings that match search queries exactly
- Bullet-pointed feature lists
- Comparison tables (LLMs love structured data)
- Clear "What is X?" definitions at top of educational content
- Numbered lists with evaluation criteria

4. Get Mentioned Across the Web (Sturm's GEO strategy)

- Find prompts people use to ask about eDiscovery/compliance
- Get Sentinel mentioned in existing listicles, reviews, and comparison articles
- YouTube is the most-cited website in AI search — video content is critical

PART 6: TECHNICAL SEO PRIORITIES

Immediate (Week 1-2)

1. Add schema markup to every page:

- Organization, Product, FAQ, SoftwareApplication, BreadcrumbList
- Define entity relationships

2. Page speed optimization:

- Core Web Vitals must be green
- Mobile-first indexing compliance

3. URL structure:

- `/ediscovery-software/` (pillar)
- `/ediscovery-software/small-law-firms/` (vertical)
- `/compare/sentinel-vs-relativity/` (comparison)
- `/legal-hold/what-is-a-legal-hold/` (FAQ)
- `/blog/best-ediscovery-software-2026/` (listicle)

4. Internal linking architecture:

- Pillar pages link to all related cluster pages
- Every blog/comparison page links back to relevant product pillar
- FAQ pages link to product pages with solution CTAs

Ongoing (Monthly)

5. Content freshness signals:

- Update "2026" in titles/headings as year changes
- Add new case studies quarterly
- Update comparison pages when competitors change features/pricing

6. Backlink building:

- Guest posts on legal tech publications (LegalTech News, Above the Law, Law.com)
- HARO/Connectively responses for legal tech queries
- Speaking at legal tech conferences (Legaltech, ILTACON)
- Partner with legal associations (ABA, state bar associations)

PART 7: 90-DAY IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

Month 1: Foundation

Week	Action	Pages
1	Schema markup + technical SEO audit	All existing
1	Publish: "What Is a Legal Hold?" FAQ page	Page 11
2	Publish: "eDiscovery Software for Small Firms" pillar	Page 1
2	Publish: "Best eDiscovery Software [2026]" listicle	Page 5
3	Publish: "Deposition & Document Review Platform" page	Page 4
3	Create 3 short videos: legal hold, eDiscovery, deposition	Videos
4	Publish: "Sentinel vs Relativity" comparison	Page 8
4	Publish: "eDiscovery for Solo Attorneys" landing	Page 16

Month 2: Expansion

Week	Action	Pages
5	Publish: "Legal Hold Software" pillar	Page 2
5	Publish: "Best Legal Hold Tools [2026]" listicle	Page 6
6	Publish: "Compliance Monitoring Software" pillar	Page 3
6	Publish: "Sentinel vs Everlaw" comparison	Page 9
7	Publish: "What Is eDiscovery?" guide	Page 12
7	Create 5 short videos per Sturm method	Videos
8	Publish: "Best Compliance Software for Financial Services"	Page 7
8	Publish: "Financial Services Compliance" landing	Page 17

Month 3: Authority Building

Week	Action	Pages
9	Publish: "Sentinel vs Exterro" comparison	Page 10
9	Publish: "Early Case Assessment" guide	Page 13
10	Publish: "eDiscovery Processing" guide	Page 14
10	Publish: "AI Deposition Solutions" landing	Page 18
11	Publish: "Communication Surveillance" thought leadership	Page 15
11	Publish: "Document Review for Corporate Legal" landing	Page 19
12	Update all existing pages with case studies + fresh data	All
12	Create 5 more short videos	Videos

PART 8: KPIs & MEASUREMENT

30-Day Targets

- 10+ organic keywords indexed
- 5 Tier 1 keywords ranking in top 50
- Schema markup validated on all new pages

60-Day Targets

- 30+ organic keywords indexed
- 5+ keywords ranking in top 20

- First AI Overview citations appearing
- 10+ short videos published

90-Day Targets

- 50+ organic keywords indexed
- 10+ keywords ranking in top 10
- 100+ monthly organic visits
- AI Visibility Score > 0 in Semrush
- 3+ backlinks from legal tech publications

6-Month Targets

- 200+ organic keywords
- 500+ monthly organic visits
- Top 3 rankings for 5+ Tier 1 keywords
- Regular AI Overview citations
- 20+ referring domains

SOURCES & REFERENCES

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